



Mood Scale

A simple printable scale for a check-in when words do not come easily. A student points to the number that feels closest to today, and that is where the conversation starts. It helps them put a name to how they are feeling.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	The one-to-five scale, from “really struggling” to “having a great day”. Laminate it if you can.

How it works

Step	What happens
1	Show the scale and ask which number feels closest to today. A student just points, so there is no writing or talking needed to start.
2	Ask gently what is behind the number, if they want to say more. If not, that is fine too. There is no wrong number.
3	Use the same scale again another day, and notice whether the number moves.

Worth knowing

- It works well at the start or end of a conversation, and alongside Conversation Starters.
- Keep the scale itself the same over time, so a student can notice their own number moving. If a low number keeps coming up, or anything sounds like a disclosure, tell your safeguarding lead the same day.

Print it once, laminate it, and it will last for years.





Which one feels closest to today?

 1 Really struggling	 2 Having a hard day	 3 Okay	 4 Feeling good	 5 Having a great day
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Point to a number. There's no wrong answer.